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Crop protection :: IPM :: Sunflower

Monitoring for Pest & Disease

- Organise regular pest and disease monitoring and assess bio-control potential at 15 days intervals.
- Observations are taken at every 5 to 10 km distance, 10 spots per ha randomly and 10 plants per spot.
- Install pheromone traps 10 per ha to monitor moth population of *Helicoverpa* and *Spodoptera litura*.

Pre-sowing stage

- Deep summer ploughing
- Clean cultivation
- Seed treatment with *T. harzianum* of *T. viride* @ 4 g/kg seed for diseases.
- Soil application of *Verticillium chlonydosperium* @ 2 Kg/ha along with compost followed by irrigation for nematode management.

Sowing stage

- Use resistant varieties
- Use certified disease free seed
- Early sowing
- Sow the crop in ridges at 15-20 cm height in cutworm endemic areas.
- Use mechanical devices to scare parakeets.
- Rogue downy mildew and sunflower necrosis disease infected plants and destroy them.

Vegetative stage

- Conserve biocontrol agents like *Cotesia* spp., spiders, anthocorids, Chrysopa, Lady bird beetles, mandits and reduvid bugs.
- Install 15 bird perches per hectare for predatory birds.
- Release 1-2 larva per plant of *Chrysoperla carnea* at early stage of crop.

Flowering stage

- Use NPV @ 250 LE/ha against *Helicoverpa* and *Spodoptera*.
- Use B.t. (K) 1 kg/ha against *Spodoptera*.
- Release 1-2 larva per plant of *Chrysoperla carnea* at early stage of crop
- Conserve bio-control agents like *Cotesia* spp., spiders, anthocorids, Chrysopa, Lady bird beetles, mandits and reduvid bugs.

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